

**BRIDGE: A Resource Information System
for Organizations Supporting Afghan Women**

Author: Lorraine P. Montero

Course: BS-Nursing 4D

Date: August 20, 2026

I. Introduction

Women in Afghanistan continue to face severe restrictions under Taliban rule. Since the Taliban returned to power in 2021, women and girls have experienced restrictions on education, employment, movement, expression, and participation in public life. Afghanistan remains the only country in the world where girls and women are formally prohibited from secondary and higher education (UNESCO, 2026). These restrictions have created barriers that affect women's ability to learn, work, access services, and participate independently in society.

Although technology cannot immediately remove these restrictions, it can provide a practical first step in improving how support reaches women. Humanitarian organizations, non-governmental organizations, educators, and other groups continue to provide different forms of assistance, but information about these services may be difficult to organize, update, and locate. An organization may provide educational programs while another provides healthcare or legal assistance, yet their services may not be easily visible in one centralized system.

In this proposal, the author seeks to address this information gap through BRIDGE, a web-based resource information system designed to help organizations find, organize, verify, and update information about services available to Afghan women. Rather than expecting women to access a new application themselves, BRIDGE focuses on strengthening the support network that already exists as a realistic first step toward improving access to assistance.

II. Problem description

The restrictions imposed on Afghan women affect many areas of daily life. One of the most serious restrictions is education. According to UNESCO (2026), approximately 2.2 million girls are excluded from secondary education, and Afghanistan is currently the only country where girls and women are formally prohibited from secondary and higher education. Women also face restrictions on employment and participation in the economy. UN Women (2025) reported that only about 24% of Afghan women participated in the labor force compared with nearly 90% of men.

Restrictions also affect women's movement and access to public services. Requirements involving a mahram, or male relative, can make it more difficult for women to travel independently and access certain services (UN Women, 2025). Women also face restrictions on their participation in public life and expression. These conditions create a situation where many women may need assistance but may have difficulty reaching or identifying appropriate services.

The problem is not simply the absence of organizations that can provide assistance. Various humanitarian and civil society organizations continue to provide education, healthcare, legal assistance, livelihood programs, and other forms of support. However, these services can be difficult to locate because information may be spread across different websites, social media pages, announcements, and organizational contacts. Information may also become outdated when programs change locations, schedules, eligibility requirements, or availability.

This creates an information gap between organizations providing support and people or groups trying to identify available services. Without an organized system, support workers may spend additional time searching for reliable information, while outdated information may lead to unsuccessful referrals.

With this problem in mind, a realistic first step is to create a centralized information system that organizes existing resources rather than attempting to directly solve the larger political and social restrictions faced by Afghan women.

III. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is BRIDGE, a web-based resource information system designed to help humanitarian organizations, non-governmental organizations, educators, and support workers locate and manage verified services available to Afghan women. The system would contain a searchable database of organizations and programs. Each resource could include the organization name, type of service, location, languages available, eligibility requirements, contact method, operating status, and date of the latest verification. Services could be organized into categories such as education, healthcare, legal assistance, livelihood programs, humanitarian aid, and psychosocial support.

One of the main features of BRIDGE would be a search and filtering system. A user could search for a specific service and location instead of manually checking multiple websites and social media pages. For example, a support worker could search for available women's education programs in a particular area and receive a list of relevant resources with their available contact methods.

Another important feature would be resource verification and status tracking. Authorized organizations could update their own information through an organization dashboard. The system could display when a resource was last verified and whether a program is currently active, temporarily unavailable, or closed. This would help reduce the use of outdated information.

BRIDGE could also include a map and list view to make resources easier to locate. However, because the situation in Afghanistan can involve security concerns, the system would avoid displaying sensitive information that could put organizations or individuals at risk. Only appropriate and publicly shareable information would be included.

The system would primarily target organizations and support workers rather than directly targeting Afghan women as individual users. This makes the project more realistic because the first stage focuses on improving coordination and information management among groups already providing assistance.

The initial version of BRIDGE could be developed as a simple web application using a database, search functionality, category filters, an administrator dashboard, and organization resource pages. A student prototype would not need to operate across all of Afghanistan. It could begin with a limited set of sample organizations and services to demonstrate how the system would work.

IV. Expected Impact

The expected impact of BRIDGE is to make information about available support more organized, searchable, and easier to maintain.

For organizations, the system could reduce the time spent searching for other available services and improve referrals between groups. For support workers, it could provide a centralized location for identifying resources based on service type and location. For the larger humanitarian network, it could provide a clearer picture of which types of support are available and where gaps may exist.

The project would not claim to restore women's freedom or solve the restrictions imposed by the Taliban. Instead, it addresses a smaller and more manageable problem: the difficulty of organizing and accessing reliable information about existing support.

BRIDGE could also serve as a foundation for future development. If the system becomes established and security conditions allow, appropriate information could eventually be made accessible through other channels such as low-bandwidth mobile services, SMS, or offline resource directories.

V. Conclusion

The restrictions placed on Afghan women under Taliban rule are a complex social and human-rights problem that cannot be solved by a single technology project. Women and girls continue to experience barriers to education, employment, movement,

expression, and participation in society. While technology cannot directly remove these restrictions, it can support organizations working to reduce their effects.

This proposal introduces BRIDGE, a web-based resource information system that organizes and verifies information about services available to Afghan women. By connecting organizations through a centralized database, searchable resources, status tracking, and simple referral information, the system provides a realistic first step toward improving coordination and access to support.

Ultimately, BRIDGE focuses on a simple idea: before technology can directly reach everyone affected by the problem, it can first strengthen the network of people and organizations already trying to help.

References

UN Women. (2025). *Afghanistan: Gender alert on the situation of women and girls*.

UN Women. (2025). *Four years of Taliban rule: Afghan women resist as restrictions tighten*.

UNESCO. (2026). *Afghanistan: Girls and women remain banned from secondary and higher education*.

United Nations Assistance Mission in Afghanistan. (2026). *Human rights situation in Afghanistan*.